

drives) on hard disks. For the sake of interoperability, most OSes that run on PCs also follow the dictates of these fundamental partition information resources.

Password Cracker

A tool to decrypt a password or password file—both for programs that take an algorithmic approach to cracking, as well as those that use brute force with a password cracking word list. Password crackers have legitimate uses by security administrators, who want to find weak passwords in order to change them and improve system security.

Password Cracking Word List

A list of words that a brute force password cracker can use to muscle its way into a system.

Payload

Refers to the effects produced by a virus attack. Sometimes refers to a virus associated with a dropper or Trojan horse.

Pervasiveness

Pervasiveness refers to a virus' potential to spread.

Polymorphic Virus

Polymorphic viruses create varied (though fully functional) copies of themselves as a way to avoid detection from anti-virus software. Some polymorphic virus use different encryption schemes and requires different decryption routines. Thus, the same virus may look completely different on different systems or even within different files. Other polymorphic viruses vary instruction sequences and use false commands in the attempt to thwart anti-virus software. One of the most advanced polymorphic viruses uses a mutation-engine and random-number generators to change the virus code and its decryption routine.

Port Scanner

In hacker reconnaissance, a port scan attempts to connect to all